richly deserve. If truth be told, they were the backbone to his rule, never once betraying him nor abusing the trust which he so unflinchingly bestowed upon them. Fakir S. Aijazuddin, the direct linear descendant of Fakir Nuruddin, recognizes the paradox even back then in the early 1800s of how it was that '[n]o one at the time could have been unaware of the anomaly of a Sikh ruler reposing so much faith in these young men, all of three belonging to another religion and that too to Islam'.[8] However, Maharajah Ranjit Singh, during whose rule there was not a single public execution of a person, may have been robbed of the sight in his left eye (as he was blinded in the left eye as a child through an affliction of small-pox), but it was said that he used his one remaining unimpaired eye more wisely than most who had two, for he used his one eye 'just so that he could view all religions with an impartial singularity',[9] treating, Hindus, Muslims and Sikhs entirely alike.

By contrast with Maharajah Ranjit Singh, Bhagat Singh's legacy is not lost in the fog of time. There are still people alive in both India and Pakistan who remember his struggle in Punjab against foreign rule. As a result, there are today an ever increasing number of people in both countries, of varying hues and tones, who wish to lay claim to his heritage. This has turned Bhagat Singh into an inscrutable and impenetrable figure in official narratives, but not necessarily so in popular and folk narratives on both sides of the border. Chris Moffat has referred to the enigma of 'Bhagat Singh's brief but eventful life as a revolutionary organizer, Bolshevik sympathizer and critic of Gandhi', but says that his name 'is celebrated from the Hindu nationalist right to the Maoist left, from Sikh militants to environmentalist youth groups, the Army in India to pacifists in Pakistan'.[10] Yet, as Moffat has also most accurately stated, Bhagat Singh is for all intents and purposes 'a figure outside the narrative of Muslim struggle curated by the Pakistan state'.[11] In an important book that has followed more recently, Moffat has argued that anti-colonial histories have a real meaning for politics in contemporary India by enabling us to understand a political terrain that, although appearing to be crowded with the dead and heroic figures from past struggles, enables us to call the living to account